

Mtech Software Engineering

Software Product Management

Assignment #1 - Group AD



A Journey through Meditative Play

Product Discovery: Applying the concepts learnt and experience of the Software Product Management

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Introduction:

The Underserved Need for Empowered Mental Wellness -The Market Landscape:
A Generation Under Pressure India has the world's largest population of young people. This generation is ambitious and tech-savvy, but also faces a major mental health crisis. A recent report showed that a staggering **80%** of India's workforce struggles with mental health issues. Young professionals aren't looking for a label or a diagnosis; they are actively seeking sophisticated tools that build resilience, sharpen their focus, and give them a competitive advantage.

Origin of the Product: Mind Play

Theme: Neurological intent, gamified mental well-being

Tagline: A journey through meditative play

Product Discovery: Mind Play

Mind Play is a mental health platform that combines neurological brain games with a strength-based pre-assessment to create personalized programs for the user which works as a front door for users who want to improve their mental health.

Rooted in the scientific foundation of **Neuroplasticity** which focuses on using the brain's ability to reorganize by forming new neural pathways, by amplifying the cognitive strengths of a person.

Mind Play delivers **bite-sized gamified sessions**, that fit into busy professional schedules. Using a low-friction reward system, help the users encourage consistency, thus improving their mental health in a daily basis.

This blend of science, gamification, and personal growth makes wellness engaging, and impactful.

Pain Points

- **Mental Fatigue & Burnout**
 - Long work hours and constant digital exposure reduce focus and memory.
 - Leads to low productivity, procrastination, and career setbacks.
 - Conventional stress-relief methods feel temporary and ineffective.
- **Passive & Unengaging Solutions**
 - Meditation and journaling apps feel repetitive and hard to sustain.
 - Lack of interactive feedback makes progress invisible.
 - Users quickly lose motivation and abandon these tools.
- **Performance Anxiety**
 - High competition pushes professionals to chase constant improvement.
 - Fear of underperforming fuels stress and self-doubt.
 - Current wellness tools don't align with ambition or career growth goals.

Target Market

B2C Customers:

- Ambitious, tech savvy individuals working in competitive environments like tech, finance, law or entrepreneurship & Students.
 - They are data-driven, focused on optimizations and are prone to mental health issues including “Brain-fog” from long hours of high stress work and needs to stay sharp for complex problem solving and decision making.

B2B Customers:

- Mid to Large Corporations, especially in high stress industries like technology, consulting and finance, trying to provide mental health services to employees.
- Educational institutions like Universities, business schools and competitive graduate programs, trying to enhance student performance and support student mental health.

Value Proposition:

We believe mental well-being should be about unlocking potential, not just solving problems. Mind Play is built on this principle. We provide a positive and engaging platform where users discover and build upon their innate cognitive strengths, using 'mental fitness' as a foundation to achieve lasting resilience and personal growth.

By framing wellness as “mental fitness,” it shifts the narrative from “what’s wrong with me?” to “how can I unlock my potential?”—helping users discover their cognitive superpowers, strengthen resilience, and achieve well-being from a foundation of strength.

Customer Interviews & Opportunity Assessment

Potential Customer	What does a High-pressure work week mean to you?	How do you manage stress?	What skills do you want to build?	Key Quote
Priya, 26 Marketing Manager	It's a constant juggle. Monday is for planning, Tuesday and Wednesday are back-to-back campaign meetings and execution. By Thursday, I'm analyzing data and putting out fires. Friday is a race to prep for the next week. I'm always 'ON' and by the end of the day, my brain feels completely fried	Honestly? Coffee. Lots of it. I try to meditate with an app sometimes, but I find it hard to stick with. It feels like another task on my to-do list. I mostly just push through it, but I know it's not sustainable. I lose focus easily by the afternoon.	I don't think I need therapy, but I definitely want to improve my focus and creative problem-solving skills under pressure. I want to build mental resilience, like a workout for my brain, so I can stay sharp and not feel so drained.	<i>"I don't want to talk about my problems, I want to train my brain to handle them better."</i>
Rohan 23, Software Engineer	A high-pressure week means a sprint deadline is looming. It's hours of coding, debugging complex problems, and very little sleep. The mental load is huge. You have to hold so much logic in your head at once, and one small mistake can break everything. It's intellectually demanding and exhausting	I usually take a break and play a quick game on my phone or watch a YouTube video. It's a temporary distraction. I've tried mindfulness apps, but they feel a bit too slow and abstract for me. I need something more engaging, something that feels productive.	I want to improve my logical reasoning and my ability to switch contexts quickly without losing my train of thought. Anything that could give me a mental edge and help me solve problems faster would be a game-changer for my career.	"Meditation feels passive. I want something active that sharpens my mind while I de-stress."

Ankit, 30 Team Lead	My week is a balancing act. I'm coding, but I'm also managing my team, resolving conflicts, and reporting to senior management. The pressure comes from all directions. I have to be the calm, stable one for my team, even when I'm feeling overwhelmed myself.	I make sure to take short walks. I used to recommend wellness apps to my team, but the uptake is always low. People see it as an admission that they're not coping. It's the stigma. Personally, I just compartmentalize and push through.	Leadership skills are key for me—specifically, emotional regulation and clear decision-making under pressure. I want to build the mental stamina to handle the context-switching without burning out. It's not about fixing a problem; it's about upgrading my mental hardware.	<i>"No one on my team will use an app that says 'mental health.' If you call it a 'performance tool,' they'll all sign up."</i>
Arohi 20, Student	Exam weeks are brutal. It's non-stop studying, group projects with tight deadlines, and the constant fear of not getting good enough grades. I feel a lot of anxiety, and it's hard to focus when you're worried about everything at once. Everyone feels it, but no one talks about it.	I listen to music to drown out the noise. I've thought about talking to a counselor, but there's a huge stigma around it on campus. I wouldn't want people to think I can't handle the pressure. So, I mostly just keep it to myself and hope for the best.	I want to learn how to manage my exam anxiety and improve my memory and concentration. I wish there was a way to train my focus, maybe through some quick, fun exercises I could do between study sessions without anyone knowing.	"I need something I can use privately on my phone for 5 minutes that helps me focus, not something that labels me as 'anxious'."

Dileep 66, Retired Professional	My weeks aren't high-pressure like they used to be, but there's a different kind of stress—the worry of staying mentally sharp. I see friends struggling with memory, and I want to keep my mind active. A typical week involves reading, puzzles, and community activities.	I play Sudoku and crossword puzzles on my tablet. It keeps my mind engaged. My son installed a brain-training app for me, and I quite enjoy the games. They're simple, and I feel a sense of accomplishment when I beat my old score. It's a nice daily habit.	My main goal is to maintain my cognitive health. I want to keep my memory strong and my mind agile. It's not about stress in the traditional sense; it's about long-term mental fitness and staying independent for as long as possible.	"I don't need a therapist, I need a daily mental workout to keep my mind as fit as my body."
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To assess the opportunity, we conducted interviews focused on understanding their current behaviors and pains, **without mentioning Mind Play directly**. These diverse interviews revealed that while pain points vary, the underlying needs for accessibility, empowerment, and ease-of-use are universal, directly shaping our product's core principles. Several factors are fueling the growth of the requirement for Mental Health applications.

The **Key drivers** are :

- **Growing Prevalence of Mental Health Issues:** Mental health conditions like anxiety and depression is on the rise globally.
- **Decreasing Stigma:** Greater awareness and public education are encouraging more people to seek help.
- **Shortage of Providers:** Significant shortage of mental health professionals when compared to demand.
- **Favorable Policies:** Governments and insurance companies are increasingly providing funding and reimbursement for telehealth and digital mental health services.

Product Idea Modification

Across all our conversations, a consistent story emerged about what users truly want. They don't want to feel "broken" or in need of fixing and they want to feel empowered and in control. This translates into four key principles for our product:

1. **Frame it as a workout, not a treatment** : Call it "mental fitness" and users will see it as a tool for getting stronger.
2. **Make the first step incredibly easy** : A 5-minute game feels like a small win, while a 1-hour appointment feels like a huge commitment.
3. **Reward the effort, not just the outcome** : Small, consistent rewards keep people motivated and coming back for more thus turning it into a habit.
4. **Start with what's right, not what's wrong** : Show the users their strengths first leading them to have higher trust in the application, prodding them to explore more.

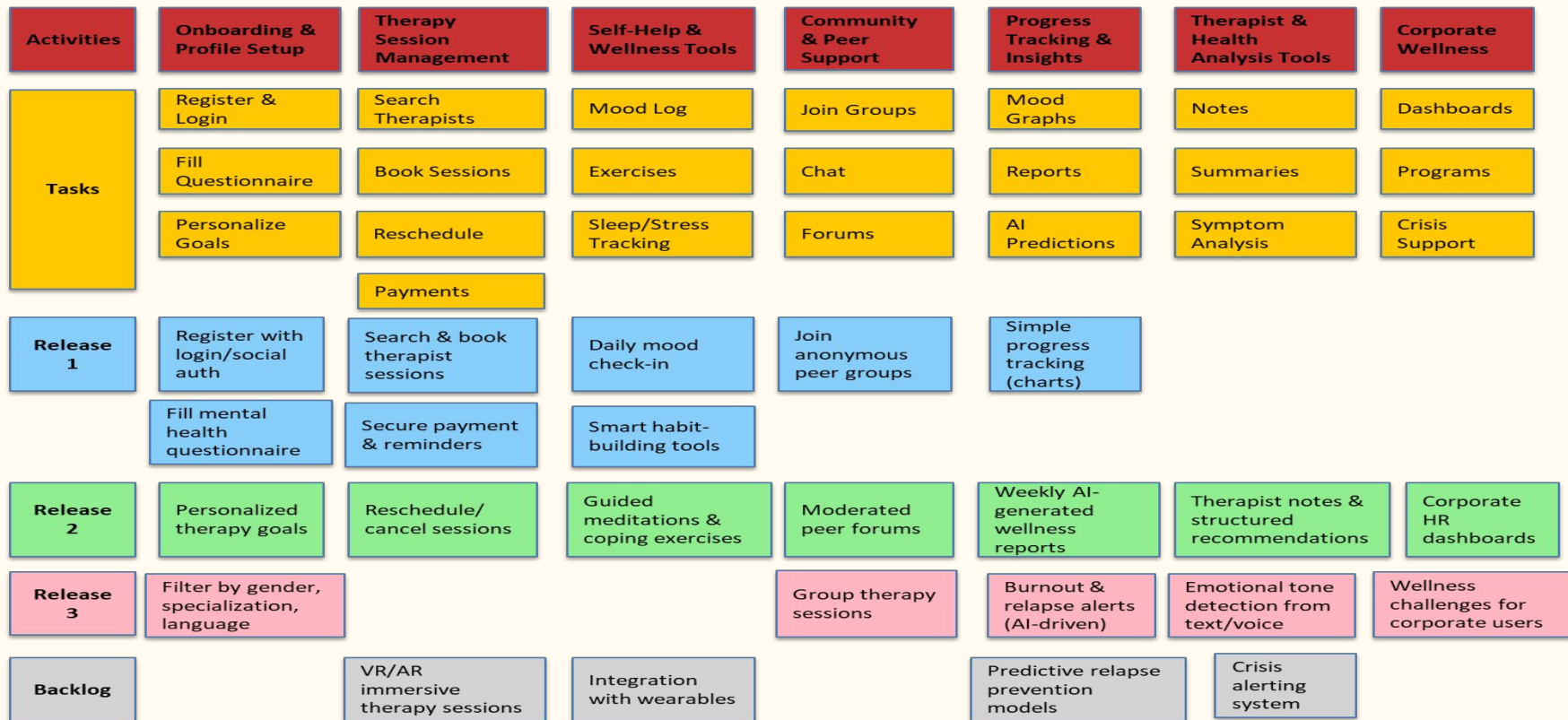
Final Product

MindPlay is a holistic “Mental Fitness” platform that acts as a trusted front-door to complete mental well-being. It uses a science backed, strength first approach to transform mental well-being into a engaging, stigma free daily habit.

How it works - User Journey:

1. **Assess & Uplift:** The journey begins with a positive, strength based pre-assessment and engaging neurological games. The app first identifies and reinforces the user’s existing cognitive strengths.
2. **Train & Rewrite:** Leveraging the principles of **Neuroplasticity**, the app delivers a personalized program of bite-sized, gamified experiences.
3. **Build the habit:** Inspired by **Atomic Habits**, a low friction reward system is implemented to encourage consistency.
4. **Connect to care:** For users seeking further support, Mind Play provides a trusted and seamless connection to a network of vetted professionals.

Story Map



Start-up Canvas



2025

PROBLEM

- > Mental health support in India is stigmatized, making people hesitant to seek help
- > Lack of convenient, private and readily available self-help tools for daily mental well-being
- > Finding a qualified and compatible therapist is a difficult, time consuming process and often unaffordable

SOLUTION

- A Unified Digital platform offering :
 - > A gamified mental health development program.
 - > 1 on 1 & group therapy sessions with vetted professionals focusing on privacy.
 - > Mental health assessments with personalized recommendations.

UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

- > Holistic, accessible and destigmatized mental wellness at your fingertips.
- > Build cognitive skills through science-backed games and connect with vetted professionals, all in one private space.

UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

- > Built on neuro-plasticity
- > A unique dataset on the cognitive patterns and wellness needs of the India youth, enabling hyper-relevant content.
- > By integrating into user's daily routine, we build a strong & loyal community.
- > Lower cost using subscription models
- > Data-driven and Measurable

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

- > B2C Segment focusing on Tech savvy professionals or students experiencing high stress, anxiety or burn-out.
- > B2B Segment consisting of Corporations and start-ups seeking to provide benefits to employees to increase productivity and retention

EXISTING ALTERNATIVES

- > Other virtual therapy applications (Amaha/ YourDost).
- > AI powered chatbots that provide mental counselling (Wysa)
- > Fitness apps with mental health modules like meditation sessions (Fitbit/ Samsung Health)
- > In person therapy centres.

KEY-METRICS

- > Daily Active Users(DAU) / Monthly Active users(MAU)
- > Conversion rate from free to paid subscription
- > Number of therapy sessions booked through the platform.
- > User retention and churn rate.

HIGH-LEVEL CONCEPT

Mental Wellness, reframed for Modern India

CHANNELS

- > Social media marketing (Instagram, LinkedIn) targeting young professionals.
- > Startup shows like Shark tank to reach the masses.
- > Partnerships with universities and corporate wellness programs.
- > Referrals and word of mouth

EARLY ADOPTERS

Tech savvy individuals that have disposable income working in high stress work environments (Software Engineers, Product Managers, Start-up founders, etc.). Primarily residents of Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities with growing penetration to other urban centres. Age between 24 to 35 years.



2025

COST STRUCTURE

- > App development and maintenance (Development, Hosting Maintenance, Support)
- > Therapist pay-outs & Commissions.
- > Marketing and Customer Acquisition Costs.
- > Salaries for the Tech, Marketing, Operations and Sales teams.
- > Content and game development cost

REVENUE STREAMS

- > Freemium model - Core games are free to build habit and user base.
- > Monthly/Annual Subscription packages - Unlocks advanced games, in-depth analytics, and access to therapy sessions (e.g., one session included per month)
- > Corporate packages – Companies register & pay for employees

Key Learnings (Kiran K Das-2025TM93130)

This assignment was a powerful lesson that building a successful product is less about having the right features and more about deeply understanding the problems you are solving. The process involved listening to users, challenging assumptions, and using strategic frameworks to create a viable product.

- **The Power of Positioning:** A critical lesson was the importance of positioning. Shifting the narrative from “mental health treatment” to “Mental Fitness” was a breakthrough that addresses the cultural stigma around mental health and makes the product more appealing.
- **Practical applications of PM Frameworks:** This assignment demonstrated the practical application of product management tools.
 - **The startup canvas** helped distill our complicated complex idea into a single page. This allowed us to confront our assumptions head-on especially regarding the customer segments and revenue plans.
 - **The user story map** allowed us to move beyond a simple feature list and allowed us to plan ahead and let us know which the core features of our product is. Moving the core habit building features to release 1 and good to have complex features (eg. AR/VR therapy sessions) to backlog gave us more clarity on how the users will be interacting with the application.
- **Bridging Vision and Execution:** Ultimately, these frameworks taught me that product management isn't just about execution; it is about building a bridge between high level vision and practical steps needed to get there. It gave us insight on why our product should exist and for whom, what we needed to build and when we needed to deliver each feature. These questions ensured that every feature we prioritized was directly tied to solving a real user problem and a viable business goal.
- **From Solution-First to Problem-First:** The most profound takeaway from this assignment was the journey from a solution-first approach to a problem-first approach. This experience helped cement my belief that the best products are created when strategy, technology and a deep understanding of the user's needs comes together to solve a meaningful problem.

Key Learnings (Shirisha Salandri-2025TM93131)

Earlier, I used to jump straight into solutions launch something, tweak for market fit, and push for profitability. This assignment taught me the power of staying longer in the problem space. **From What to Build → Why We Build** Customer discovery isn't just a checkbox, it's the foundation.

- The most critical moment was realizing that our product, Mind Play, wasn't just competing with other apps, it was competing with the cultural stigma around mental health. This insight, gained during discovery, reshaped our entire value proposition from a simple "**brain game app**" to a "**stigma-free entry point to mental wellness.**"
- The Lean Canvas and User Story Map became game changers. The canvas exposed our riskiest assumptions in one place and forced us to rethink the revenue model eventually steering us towards B2B wellness.
- **Frameworks Are Practical Tools, Not Theory** The story map helped us see the emotional journey of users and made MVP priorities crystal clear: first win trust through strengths discovery, then expand into therapy.

I stopped seeing a product as a fixed blueprint and started seeing it as a set of testable hypotheses.

Products Are Living Hypotheses. We began with a game idea, but quickly learned the real value was in creating a trusted platform focused on privacy, habits, and care. The games weren't the product itself, but a tool to build trust.

Key Learnings (Sunanda Pandita-2025TM93132)

Being part of a team working on this assignment has taught me umpteen lessons within the scope of this activity and beyond like

- How it is crucial to position mental wellness as a strength-based journey that empowers users, rather than a treatment.
- Understanding real customer needs is critical — not just what they say, but why they need it. Continuous user research and feedback loops prevent building unused features.
- Evaluating the opportunity, customer interviews, target market and value proposition design are all interconnected and work together to create a **holistic view of the product**.
- Successful products are created when empathy, science, and technology are combined to address genuine human needs.
- In addition, this activity enabled me to work with my peers remotely whom I have never met or seen, still we all have put our insights logically and effectively to come to a solution while at times differing in opinions which were resolved with analytical reasoning and respecting each other's perspective. It has taught me a lot about human behaviour, trust, accountability and collaboration dynamics. I can't conclude without mentioning the motivational support extended by the members to complete this activity while being occupied with our routine work hustle.

Key Learnings (Rahul-2025TM93133)

Working on this assignment helped me understand how product discovery goes beyond just identifying a problem—it is about deeply listening to users, analyzing their pain points, and framing solutions in a way that feels natural and engaging. I learned how important it is to position mental wellness not as a treatment but as a strength-based journey that empowers users. The exercise also gave me clarity on how opportunity assessment, customer interviews, and value proposition design all connect together to create a holistic product vision. Most importantly, I realized that successful products are built when empathy, science, and technology come together to solve real human needs.

Key Learnings (Sushant Chaudhari-2025TM93134)

- We realized that mental health tools often miss the mark — young professionals and students want something practical, not just another meditation app.
- The idea of “mental fitness” felt like a breakthrough. Framing it as strength-building, not fixing problems, makes the product more empowering.
- Talking to real users gave us powerful insights: some need anonymity, some need flexibility, and others (like seniors or parents) need simplicity and guidance.
- Building MindPlay showed us how neuroplasticity + gamification can make wellness feel less like a chore and more like a daily habit.
- From a product management angle, we saw the importance of starting small (MVP), validating assumptions, and aligning features to real pain points.
- On the technical side, the project highlighted the need for scalable AI-driven personalization, smooth UX, and strong security to gain user trust.
- Strategically, we learned to balance B2C personalization with B2B opportunities like companies and universities — opening up multiple growth paths.
- Most importantly, we learned that a holistic journey — from quick assessments to habit-building and even connecting to professionals — is what makes the product truly valuable.

Conclusion

Mind Play represents a shift in how mental wellness is approached—moving away from problem-centric solutions toward a proactive model of mental fitness. By combining neuroscience, gamification, and a strength-first framework, it transforms wellness into an engaging, stigma-free habit. The insights from customer interviews validate the need for a platform that is accessible, easy to use, and adaptable to diverse user groups ranging from students to professionals and families.

Looking ahead, the platform can scale to both B2C and B2B markets by offering personalized programs for individuals while enabling organizations and institutions to support mental well-being at scale. Integration of AI-driven personalization, voice-first interfaces, and predictive analytics can further enhance user experience and engagement. With its holistic journey—from assessment to habit-building and seamless access to care—Mind Play positions itself not just as another mental health app, but as a trusted partner in empowering individuals to unlock their potential and build sustainable resilience for the future.

Thank you!